



VIFM Fluent

AI-Assisted English Placement for the GCC

Four CEFR-aligned skills. A defensible English level in minutes. English or Arabic, at any scale.

Virginia Institute of Finance and Management · Confidential client briefing

THE CHALLENGE

Why English placement matters

In GCC banking and government, English proficiency drives client communication, compliance, cross-border work, and leadership readiness.

Yet traditional placement is:

- Slow - days or weeks to schedule, sit, and mark.
- Costly - human raters at every sitting.
- Inconsistent - scores drift between raters and sessions.
- Hard to scale - across large hiring and development cohorts.

Decisions need a fast, consistent, defensible read of each person's English - VIFM Fluent delivers it in minutes.

AT A GLANCE

4

CEFR-aligned skills measured

6

CEFR levels (A1 - C2)

2

languages of delivery (EN / AR)

Minutes

to a scored result + feedback

What VIFM Fluent is

A four-skill, CEFR-aligned English placement assessment - AI-authored, AI-scored, and human-calibrated.

Four skills, one standard

Reading, Listening, Writing and Speaking, each banded A1-C2, with an overall CEFR level.

AI-assisted, human-calibrated

Claude authors items and scores writing/speaking against a CEFR rubric; humans calibrate the model.

Bilingual & accessible

English or Arabic interface with full RTL; runs in any browser, no install.

Flexible deployment

Self-served and anonymous, or administered for a named candidate - standalone or inside Pre-Hire.

Positioned honestly as an INDICATIVE placement to inform a human decision - fast and consistent, with a calibration pathway toward certification.

Four skills - receptive and productive

Two receptive skills (auto-scored) and two productive skills (scored against a CEFR rubric). Each is banded A1-C2 and rolls up to an overall level.

READING

RECEPTIVE · AUTO-SCORED

Understanding written English: gist, detail, inference, and vocabulary in context.

LISTENING

RECEPTIVE · AUTO-SCORED

Understanding spoken English from a single hearing: gist, detail, inference, discourse and flow.

WRITING

PRODUCTIVE · RUBRIC-SCORED

Producing written English for a workplace task - judged on seven criteria (see methodology).

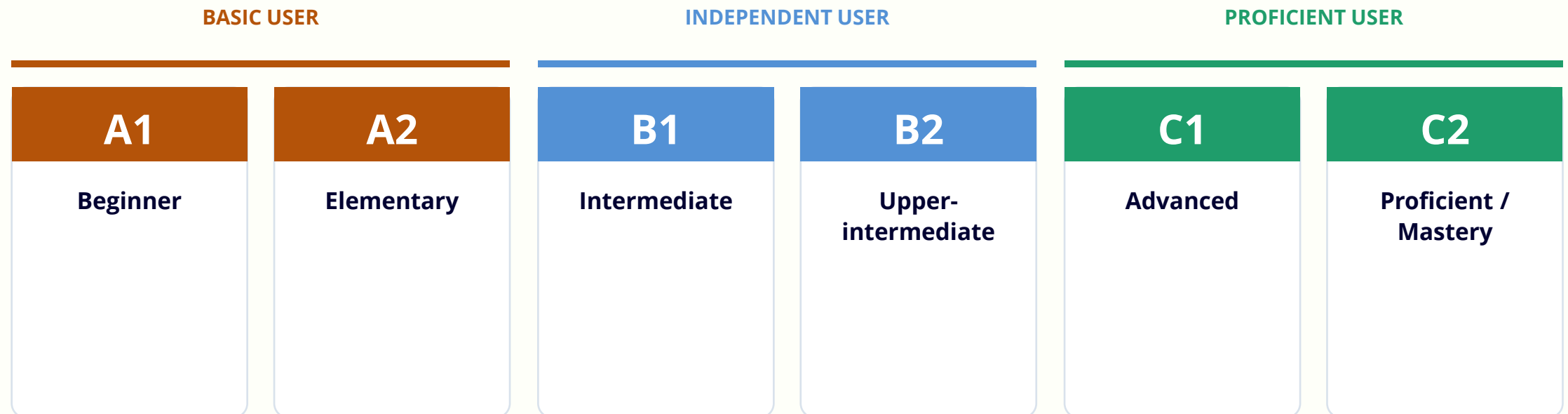
SPEAKING

PRODUCTIVE · RUBRIC-SCORED

Producing spoken English in response to a prompt - judged on four criteria plus pronunciation.

Reported on the CEFR scale

The Common European Framework of Reference for Languages is the global standard for describing language ability. VIFM Fluent reports every skill and the overall result on this scale - so results are portable and internationally understood.



Each criterion is rated 1-5; per-skill scores map to a CEFR band, and a borderline result is reported as a confidence range rather than a false-precise single level.

How the assessment works



Receptive skills (Reading & Listening)

AI-authored multiple-choice items, auto-scored server-side. Listening items play neural text-to-speech audio.



Productive skills (Writing & Speaking)

The candidate produces real language; Claude scores it criterion-by-criterion against a CEFR-aligned rubric.



Speaking capture

The spoken response is transcribed in the browser (no install), with optional pronunciation analysis blended in.



Integrity by design

The answer key never reaches the browser, grading happens server-side, and each test session is single-use.

What the productive skills are judged on

Each criterion is rated 1-5 and rolls up to a CEFR band for the skill.

WRITING - 7 criteria

- Task achievement
- Coherence & cohesion
- Lexical resource
- Grammar range & accuracy
- Register (business-like tone)
- Etiquette & courtesy
- Mechanics (spelling & punctuation)

SPEAKING - 4 criteria + pronunciation

- Fluency
- Coherence
- Lexical resource
- Grammar range & accuracy
- Pronunciation (clarity, stress, intonation)

Reading & Listening are scored objectively from the auto-marked items (gist, detail, inference, vocabulary / discourse).

Built to stand up to scrutiny

Human-calibrated

Writing and speaking scores are re-rated by trained humans; model-vs-human agreement is tracked by Quadratic Weighted Kappa (target ≥ 0.70).

Advisory integrity signal

Tab-switches, paste activity and mid-test location changes are flagged for review - surfaced to staff, never an automatic fail.

Honest positioning

An indicative placement that informs a human decision - transparently labelled, never an automated gate.

Calibration pathway

A growing item bank with IRT groundwork moves Fluent toward adaptive testing and a certification track.

What candidates and clients get

CANDIDATE EXPERIENCE

- Browser-based - nothing to install, any device.
- English or Arabic, full right-to-left support.
- A single focused sitting; scored in minutes.
- Self-served anonymously, or run for a named candidate.

DELIVERABLES

Per-skill report (PDF)

CEFR level + per-skill narratives, criterion-by-criterion detail, specific writing issues, and the advisory integrity signal.

CEFR certificate (PDF)

A clean, shareable statement of the placement level.

Pipeline integration

Plugs in as a stage of VIFM Pre-Hire screening, or runs standalone for placement and development.

Why VIFM Fluent

- **Fast** - a defensible English read in minutes, at any scale.
- **Consistent** - the same rubric every time; no rater drift.
- **Bilingual & GCC-built** - English / Arabic, tuned for banking and government.
- **Honest & defensible** - indicative, human-calibrated, transparently positioned.

Next step: run a pilot cohort, or integrate Fluent into your hiring funnel.